

The Operational Self-Check

Seven questions. About five minutes. A number that tells you whether your business is over-dependent on its best people.

How to use this: Read each question and circle the number that best matches your business today. Add up your scores at the end. Page 2 tells you what your total means.

Q01

If your two best people each took a two-week vacation at the same time, how disrupted would operations be?

- [0] Barely noticed.
- [1] Some delays, manageable.
- [2] Significant slowdown across the team.
- [3] Operations would seriously break down.

Q02

What share of your team's day is spent on repetitive, rules-based work (status updates, ticket triage, data entry, routine customer questions)?

- [0] Less than 10%.
- [1] 10–25%.
- [2] 25–50%.
- [3] More than 50%.

Q03

Could you document, end to end, exactly how your best person makes their most common decisions?

- [0] Yes — it's fully written down.
- [1] Partially documented.
- [2] Documented, but stale or unreliable.
- [3] It lives in their head.

Q04

How long until a new hire performs at the level of your experienced staff?

- [0] Days.
- [1] A few weeks.
- [2] Several months.
- [3] Six months or longer — or it never quite happens.

Q05

How often does work get stuck waiting on one specific person?

- [0] Rarely.
- [1] Weekly.
- [2] Daily.
- [3] Multiple times a day.

Q06

If inbound volume doubled next month (tickets, leads, projects, calls), what would break first?

- [0] Nothing — we'd scale fine.
- [1] Quality of work would drop.
- [2] Response times would collapse.
- [3] We'd have to stop accepting new work.

Q07

Roughly how much would you save annually if your top performer never had to touch Tier-1 work (basic questions, status checks, routine triage)?

- [0] Less than \$20K.
- [1] \$20K–\$50K.
- [2] \$50K–\$150K.
- [3] More than \$150K.

YOUR TOTAL SCORE

_____ / 21

Reading your score

Higher scores mean your business is more dependent on individual people — which is exactly where automating expertise creates the most value.

0–7

Already systemized

Your operations don't depend on heroics. You probably don't need us right now. If anything is dragging, it's likely a specific tool or hire — not an expertise problem.

8–14

Meaningful drag

You have real operational friction. Specific roles or workflows are bottlenecks, and they're costing you money you can't easily see. An audit usually surfaces \$50K–\$200K in annual savings at this level.

15–21

Over-dependent

Your business runs on the judgment of a few people. When they're busy, everything slows. When they leave, the knowledge leaves with them. This is where our work creates the most leverage — and where the cost of doing nothing compounds the fastest.

What this number doesn't tell you

A score is a signal, not a diagnosis. It says *where* the leverage is, not *what* to build. The questions above are deliberately broad — every business answers them differently, and the same score can mean two very different things depending on your industry, your team's structure, and what your top performers actually do all day.

If your score is 8 or higher, the next step is a 30-minute audit. We walk through your operations, identify the most expensive bottleneck, and tell you exactly what can and can't be automated. If the number isn't worth it, we'll tell you that too.

Want us to model your numbers?

Book a free 30-minute operational audit. No obligations. No pitch deck.

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